SPECTRALBRIDGE / EARTH LAB

A different light on the same landscape

An aircraft measures more colors of light than our eyes can see.
A flightline is the strip of ground recorded along the aircraft's path.

01 Start with a familiar view

Visible light: red + green + blue, similar to a color photograph.

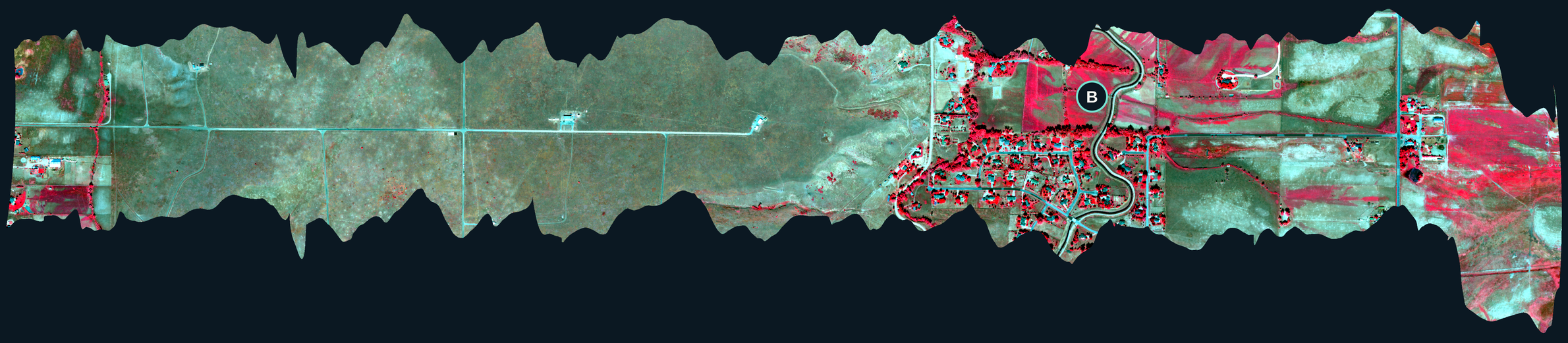
A A straight road helps you match the views.

Dark background lies outside the flightline; it is not a land-cover color.

B Follow this same patch in all three images.

02 Reveal invisible light

Near-infrared light is shown in red. Vegetated areas often stand out.



B This patch appears bright red in this view.

Red is a display choice here. It does not mean heat or fire.

03 Switch the infrared channels

Shortwave infrared is shown in red; near-infrared is shown in green.

B The same patch now appears green.

The ground has not changed: we changed which light becomes each screen color.

ONE FLIGHT. THREE WAYS TO SEE IT.

SpectralBridge helps researchers process airborne light measurements and compare landscapes across wavelengths and sensor scales.

Read the colors as clues, not a map of plant species or a measurement of plant health.

Real NEON imagery | R10C | 15 September 2021 | Native 1 m pixels | Same footprint in every view

Colors enhanced for visibility: each channel uses a 2-98% contrast stretch and gamma 0.8.

Selected bands near 650/550/470 nm; 850/650/550 nm; 1650/850/650 nm (screen red/green/blue).

Source: archived BRDF/topographic-corrected flightline | earthlab/spectralbridge | Curated 27 October 2026